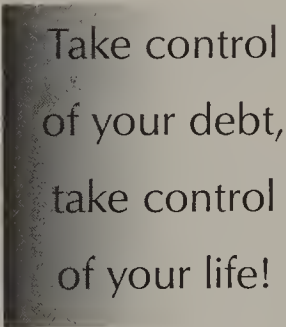


If Ed and Sue, along with their neighbors who are facing bankruptcy, and the rest of us, the average hard-working citizens, only had to pay back the principle of the debt we incurred, plus a bit of fair interest, there would be no debt epidemic in this country. Ed and Sue studied their credit card bills and realized that what they originally had charged was only about half of the total amount they now owed. They were paying on a balance that was twice as much as when they started. Their next-door neighbors had gotten in over their heads with credit card debt when the company that they both worked for moved its operations out of the country. They both lost their jobs. The bills piled up, and they felt that they had no other option...except to file bankruptcy. It happens every day to people we know – our friends, our families, our neighbors.

Beating the Bully

There are a record number of bankruptcies filed every year. Every year since 2003, there have been more bankruptcies than people graduating college and more Americans going bankrupt than getting divorced. The number of bankruptcies is on the rise each year. Why? The nasty truth is that the banks and the credit card companies set their customers up to fail.

They want us in perpetual debt because that is how they make their money. That is how they make, in an insider's own words, their *obscene* profits. My Encarta dictionary defines obscene as "offensive to conventional standards of decency" and "morally offensive." I have to say that their practices are indeed offensive to my own standards of decency, and personally, I am morally offended.



Take control
of your debt,
take control
of your life!

Instead of just being offended and wanting to punch somebody out, we can do something about it. We can learn their secrets and their traps, and how to avoid them. Then we can tell everyone we know what we have learned and teach them the secrets as well. That is how to really hit them where it hurts.